When African American journalist William Worthy traveled to Cuba in 1961 without a passport – his had already been revoked when he traveled to China a few years earlier – he was arrested upon re-entry to the United States. “William Worthy isn’t worthy to enter our door,” folksinger Phil Ochs sang satirically, “Went down to Cuba, he’s not American any more. But somehow it is strange to hear the State Department say, ‘You are living in the Free World, in the Free World you must stay’.”

Notes

1 Silvio Rodríguez, “Canción urgente para Nicaragua.”

2 Bonsal, *Cuba, Castro, and the United States*, pp. 42–3.

3 Braddock to Department of State, January 6, 1959. *Foreign Relations of the United States (FRUS) 1958–60*, VI, p. 346. These same businessmen had previously urged that the United States support a military coup to prevent a revolutionary victory; in that case, the Ambassador decided not to follow their advice, although he agreed that the United States “should not be [a] silent spectator.” Instead of a coup, he urged the State Department to convince Batista to relinquish the presidency to a civilian backed by the military – perhaps a difference more semantic than real. This incident is described in Paterson, *Contesting Castro*, p. 201.

4 Bonsal, *Cuba, Castro, and the United States*, p. 28.

5 Memorandum by the Assistant Secretary of State for Inter-American Affairs’ Special Assistant (Hill). “Briefing Memorandum-Cuba” February 6, 1959. *FRUS 1958–60*, p. 397.

6 Director of the Office of Mexican and Caribbean Affairs (Weiland) to Assistant Secretary of State for Inter American Affairs (Rubottom), February 19, 1959. *FRUS, 1958–60*, VI, p. 406.

7 Telegram from Embassy in Cuba to the Department of State, May 11, 1959. *FRUS 1958–60*, VI, pp. 507–8.

8 Pérez, *Cuba: Between Reform and Revolution*, p. 320.

9 Bonsal, *Cuba, Castro, and the United States*, p. 72.